

STRATEGIST

CASTELLANI ALESSANDRO



PORTFOLIO

INDEX

ABOUT ME

04 — About Me

RESEARCH / STRATEGY

06 — Research / Strategy

08 — La Gazza Ladra

14 — Pigro

24 — Nikon Base-Archive

34 — DJ Skills & Pills

44 — V-Archive

ART CURATING / EDITORIAL

50 — Art Curating / Editorial

52 — Chiaromonte

62 — Tuina

68 — Cessi

CONTACTS

75 — Contacts

ABOUT ME

Born in Turin | IED Torino | Budapest Metropolitan University

I work as a strategist, focusing on research, insights and cultural positioning.

My practice sits at the intersection of visual culture, branding and contemporary art, where I develop frameworks that define direction before form. Through my work with Nationhood, I've been involved in projects that combine strategic thinking with cultural sensitivity, translating complex contexts into clear and relevant narratives for brands and institutions.

My background in Communication Design, together with an international experience in Budapest, shaped an approach that moves from observation to insight, and from insight to structure.

I'm particularly interested in working with brands, studios and cultural institutions that operate within the art world, where positioning, storytelling and curatorial thinking become part of the same process.

RESEARCH

STRATEGY

LA GAZZA LADRA

Creative Direction & Brand Development
Client | La Gazza Ladra | 2025



La Gazza Ladra is an independent jewellery brand founded in New York by Valentina Castellani. I developed the brand's creative direction, defining a coherent visual and narrative language capable of expressing its artistic influences, handcrafted approach and distinctive identity.

My work focused on shaping the way the brand presents itself across different contexts, from the selection and direction of visual materials to the development of its positioning and communication. The creative direction was also applied to a dedicated presentation for Antonia Milano, designed to introduce La Gazza Ladra within a high-end retail environment while preserving its independent and culturally driven character.





Ogni collana è realizzata
direttamente da

Valentina Castellani.

Nessun laboratorio esterno,
nessuna replica seriale.



HANDMA

DE, INTENTIONALLY



PIGRO

Urban Wellbeing Strategy & Integrated Communication

Client | Comune di Torino | 2026

Pigro was developed in response to a brief from the City of Turin, which asked for a new way to reposition the city's green spaces through the selection and enhancement of a specific urban park.

Starting from Parco del Valentino, the project reframes public green space as an accessible environment for everyday wellbeing. The strategy is based on the insight that people do not reject wellbeing itself, but the time, discipline and organisation often associated with it.

Pigro transforms the park into an urban space for spontaneous rest, relaxation and sociality, combining guided activities, freely accessible areas and immersive experiences. A three-phase communication strategy extends the project across the city through guerrilla activations, outdoor campaigns, social content, digital booking tools and temporary urban installations.

I developed the project across research, communication strategy, positioning, naming, concept development, tone of voice, copywriting, experience design, campaign planning, art direction, social content, digital touchpoints and mockup development.











Brand Repositioning & Integrated Campaign | 2026

Nikon Base-Archive is a repositioning project designed to re-connect Nikon with Gen Z and Millennials under 35. In a context where AI-generated and manipulated images are weakening trust in visual evidence, the strategy reframes Nikon not simply as a camera manufacturer, but as a witness to reality. The project proposes a digital system that allows Nikon users to certify and preserve 36 authentic photographs per year, transforming each image into verifiable evidence of a lived moment. The concept is activated through an integrated campaign spanning OOH, social media, digital platforms, a public photo contest, editorial outputs and exhibition experiences.

I worked on context and target research, strategic positioning, concept development, customer journey and campaign architecture.

GLI UNDER35 SCATTANO
PER PROVARE CHE
STANNO VIVENDO

Ma se ogni immagine può essere costruita,
anche questa prova scompare

archive Nikon Campagna di riposizionamento

NiKON

BASE—ARCHIVE

il primo sistema di **certificazione**
e **archiviazione digitale** di **immagini**
autentiche dedicato ai clienti Nikon

Pixel Perfect

il meccanismo è semplice

/01



SCATTA

Cattura il momento con
il tuo dispositivo ottico
Nikon verificabile

/02



CARICA

Trasferisci l'immagine
nel tuo archivio
personale protetto

/03



CERTIFICA

Verifica automatica
dell'autenticità attraverso
i metadati RAW

/04



SIGILLA

Applicazione del sigillo
crittografico irreversibile
con tecnologie blockchain

/05



CONSERVA

Preservazione
permanente nell'archivio

Ogni utente Nikon può certificare
36 FOTO ALL'ANNO
come prove verificabili di realtà



VERIFICATA

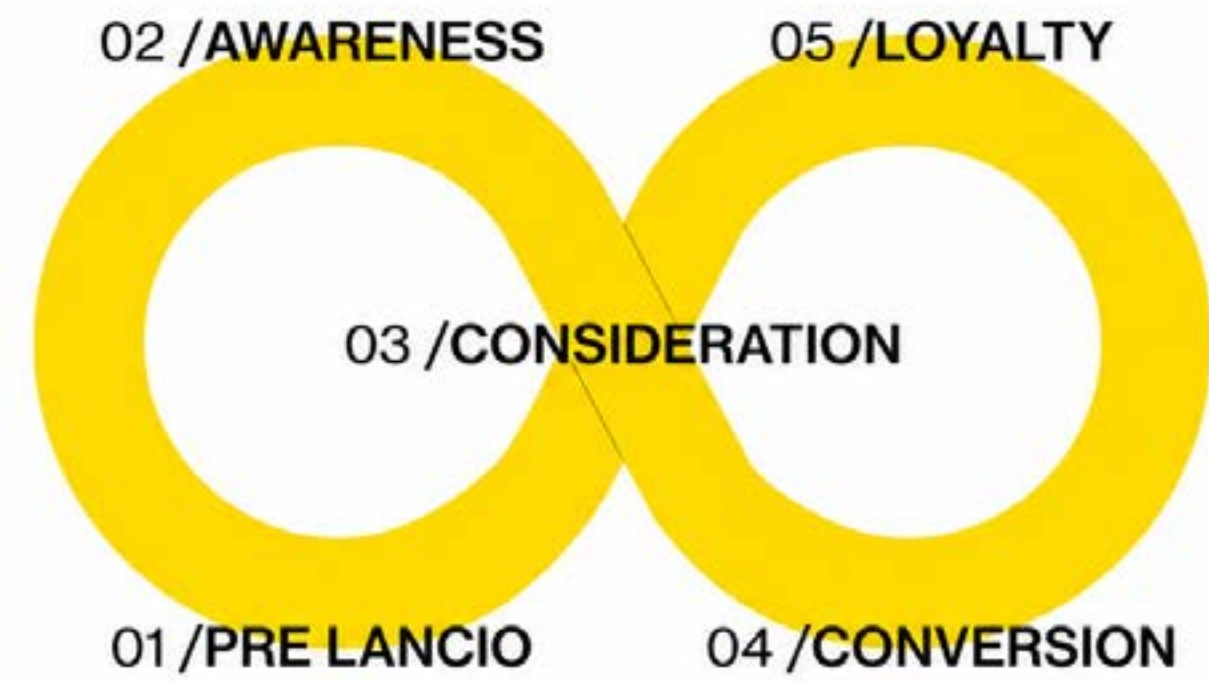
F. Marino
09:15



VERIFICATA

P. Romano
08:42

CUSTOMER JOURNEY





DJ SKILLS & PILLS

Market Research | Analysis & Creative Outputs | 2026

DJ Skills & Pills explores the development of an integrated ecosystem for DJs and music producers, based on an in-depth analysis of the electronic music industry and its structural dynamics.

The research revealed a fragmented landscape, where education, distribution, community, content and monetisation are managed through separate platforms. This makes it difficult for emerging artists to build sustainable careers and maintain direct control over their professional development.

The strategic and creative outcome is the Contemporary Listening Bar, conceived as the physical, cultural and economic core of the ecosystem. Beyond hosting curated listening experiences and community-driven events, the venue is designed to evolve into a record label and recording studio, generating content, opportunities and revenue capable of supporting the digital platform and its community.

I worked on market and competitor research, ecosystem analysis, strategic positioning, concept development and the definition of the project's cultural and business model.

SKILLS AND PILLS

RESEARCH

MARKET OVERVIEW

THE ELECTRONIC MUSIC INDUSTRY CONTINUES TO GROW STEADILY.

GLOBAL MARKET VALUE:
\$12.9B in 2024

FORECAST:
\$19.6B by 2033

KEY DRIVERS

- STREAMING PLATFORMS
- GLOBAL FESTIVAL CULTURE
- RISE OF INDEPENDENT ARTISTS
- DIGITAL PRODUCTION TOOLS

THE ELECTRONIC MUSIC INDUSTRY HAS EXPERIENCED STEADY GLOBAL GROWTH OVER THE PAST DECADE, DRIVEN BY STREAMING PLATFORMS, FESTIVAL CULTURE AND THE RISE OF INDEPENDENT ARTISTS.

ELECTRONIC MUSIC NICHES REPRESENT ONLY ~10% OF THE GLOBAL MUSIC MARKET, BUT GENERATE DISPROPORTIONATE CULTURAL INFLUENCE.

NTNHD

FEB 2026

ECOSYSTEM OF THE DJ INDUSTRY

The DJ economy is structured across multiple revenue streams, combining live performances, digital platforms and direct audience relationships. These activities operate across different environments, creating a system that is inherently fragmented and difficult to navigate as a whole.

HOW DJs MAKE MONEY

Live performances remain the primary source of income, while streaming, merchandising and brand collaborations represent secondary but growing revenue streams. This distribution highlights a strong dependence on physical presence, with digital channels still playing a supporting role rather than a central one.

COMPETITOR ECOSYSTEM

The ecosystem is divided into distinct categories, each covering a specific function such as streaming, education, distribution or community. This separation reinforces the fragmentation of the system, requiring artists to navigate multiple platforms to build their practice.

SKILLS AND PILLS

RESEARCH

DIRECT COMPETITORS

BOILER ROOM:
MEDIA PLATFORM FOCUSED ON LIVE PERFORMANCES. ITS STRENGTH LIES IN STORYTELLING AND CULTURAL POSITIONING, BUT IT DOES NOT PROVIDE EDUCATIONAL OR MONETIZATION TOOLS FOR DJS.

DIGITAL DJ TIPS:
EDUCATION PLATFORM FOR BEGINNER DJS. THE PLATFORM FOCUSES PRIMARILY ON SKILL DEVELOPMENT RATHER THAN CAREER INFRASTRUCTURE.

CERCLE:
PREMIUM AUDIOVISUAL PERFORMANCE PLATFORM. ITS POSITIONING IS PREMIUM AND PERFORMANCE-FOCUSED, RATHER THAN COMMUNITY OR EDUCATION-DRIVEN.

RESIDENT ADVISOR:
EDITORIAL PLATFORM FOR ELECTRONIC MUSIC CULTURE. WHILE INFLUENTIAL IN THE SCENE, IT OPERATES PRIMARILY AS A MEDIA AND TICKETING ECOSYSTEM.

EACH COMPETITOR CONTROLS ONE PART OF THE ECOSYSTEM ONLY.

NTNHD

FEB 2026

FROM THE PAIN POINTS TO THE OPPORTUNITIES

DJ PAIN POINTS

Despite the rapid growth of the electronic music industry, DJs still face structural challenges in building sustainable careers. The ecosystem is fragmented, with multiple disconnected platforms and limited opportunities for direct monetization. Most DJs lack business tools and rely heavily on social media, making their growth unstable and difficult to control. As a result, building a long-term, sustainable career remains a major challenge.

OPPORTUNITIES

This fragmentation reveals a clear opportunity: to create a unified platform that supports DJs throughout their entire professional journey. An ecosystem that integrates education, community, and monetization can provide independent DJs with the tools they currently lack. Skills & Pills positions itself as a centralized infrastructure, transforming a scattered landscape into a cohesive and sustainable system.

CONTEMPORARY LISTENING BAR



V-ARCHIVE

Archive Strategy, Research & Project Management | 2026

V-Archive is a platform and strategic service dedicated to the creation, management and activation of digital archives for companies and cultural institutions.

The project rethinks the archive as more than a technical repository, transforming it into a dynamic, searchable and operational system capable of preserving content while creating new cultural and strategic value. While its initial focus is on digital archives, V-Archive is designed to expand into the development and management of physical archives, connecting digital infrastructure, curatorial thinking and spatial organisation.

The projects presented include Archivio Santa Maria Novella and Archivio Slam Jam. I work as project manager across both projects, supporting client relationships, project coordination, research and the development of new fields of application for V-Archive.

I also contribute to the platform's creative development, taking part in brainstorming, identity definition and the translation of strategic insights into concepts, narratives and project directions.



- ATMOSFEAR - 06:19 - 1996 A.SJ.2020.W7MUSI.W700VIN.0340 - GLENN UNDERGROUND - ENTERCOURSE OF THE NEW AGE - ATMOSF PAUSE

ARCHIVIO SLAM JAM

SLAM JAM

MANIFESTO CONTACT

FROM ITS EMERGENCE AS AN UNDERGROUND PIONEER IN 1989 RIGHT UP TO BECOMING AN ICONIC DIGITAL AND PHYSICAL PLATFORM, SLAM JAM HAS EVOLVED INTO A POWERFUL SOCIO-CULTURAL CATALYST FOR MULTIPLE GENERATIONS OF LIKE-MINDED PEOPLE. SINCE THE START, ITS NAME HAS RESONATED WITHIN THE CREATIVE COMMUNITIES OF EACH DECADE. SLAM JAM IS A MULTIDIMENSIONAL INSTITUTION WITH A SHARED PURPOSE. IT IS A DEMOCRATIC FORM OF GLOBAL EXPRESSION WHERE HIGH AND LOW, PAST AND FUTURE, UNDERGROUND AND MAINSTREAM FLOW INTO THE SAME MELTING POT. FROM LOCAL CULTURES TO THE AVANT-GARDE. FROM THE COLLECTIVE MEMORY TO YOUTH



ART CURATING

EDITORIAL

CHIAROMONTE

Contemporary Art Platform & Ongoing Curatorial System |
2026

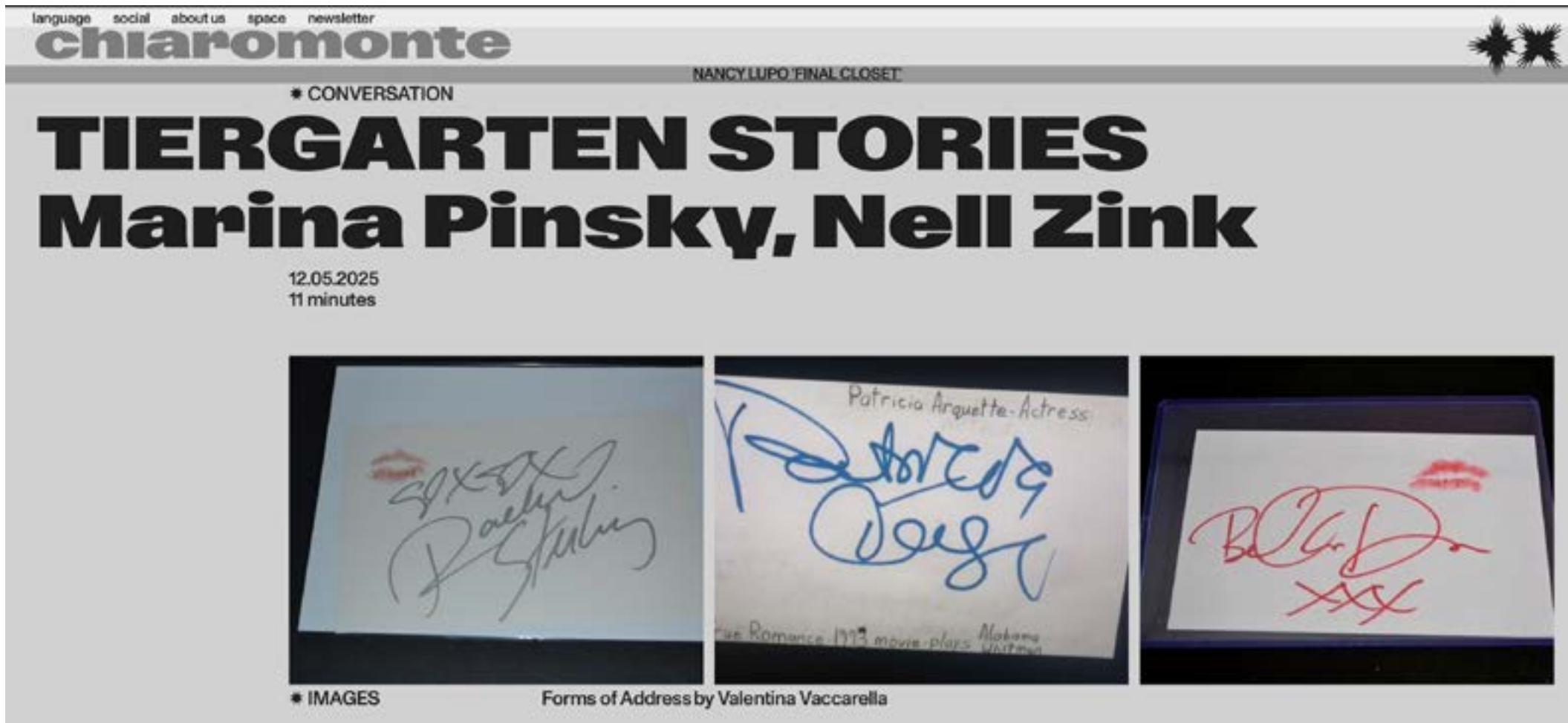
Chiaromonte is a digital art platform developed by Nationhood, conceived as a space where contemporary artistic practices are collected, structured, and made accessible through a custom-built online environment.

Rather than presenting artworks in a traditional editorial format, the project operates as a living archive, where content is continuously organized and activated through the interface.

I worked as Assistant Curator, supporting both the curatorial and operational side of the platform.

My role focused on managing the website backend: uploading and structuring artworks, organizing content, and ensuring consistency across metadata and visual materials.

This meant translating curatorial logic into a functional digital system, contributing to the coherence between the project's conceptual direction and its execution online.

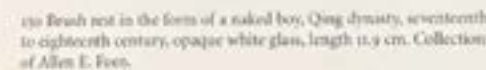


CONCEPT

Chiaromonte rethinks the idea of the archive as a static repository, transforming it into a navigable and dynamic system.

The platform is designed to let users explore artworks through a non-linear structure, where relationships between pieces, artists, and materials emerge through interaction rather than hierarchy.

The website itself becomes part of the curatorial process: not just a container, but a tool that shapes how the work is experienced.



*BRUSHREST IN THE FORM OF A NAKED BOY, QING DYNASTY, SEVENTEENTH TO EIGHTEENTH CENTURY, OPAQUE WHITE GLASS, LENGTH

IMAGES 06.06.2025 images-06

Fueled by the boom of Taiwan's music industry and cross-cultural exchanges across Asia, the genre of Mandarin Pop—an amalgam of traditional Chinese musical elements with R&B and synth-pop—peaked in the 1990s as a pan-Asian phenomenon before extending across the global Chinese diaspora. Its influence evolved as the industry shifted toward mainland China in the late 1990s and 2000s, but Mandarin Pop's echoes resonate in Peng Zuqiang's video *Autocorrects* (2023). Here, the artist presents a selection of photographs of objects that informed the work, offering insight into its sources of inspiration and methodological frameworks.

Peng Zuqiang works with film, video and installations. Recent solo presentations include *Vestiges*, Fondazione Sandretto (2023); *Kevin Space* (2023); *Sideways Looking*, Cell Project Space (2022); *Souvenirs of Frictions*, E-Flux screening room (2022). Group exhibitions and screenings:

auditor - share

Notes on contributors

[language](#) [social](#) [about us](#) [space](#) [newsletter](#)

IMAGES 06.15.2025 images: 04

Sofia Sinibaldi builds images through layered accumulation, merging photography and portable scanner capture to create figures that exist in conversation with one another. Her recent focus turns to New York's City Hall, territory she crosses daily between home and studio. The courthouse draws her attention as a stage where media converges and power becomes visible, and her work captures the ceremonial rhythms and physical presence of civic institutions.

Sofia Sinibaldi (1992, Guatemala City) lives and works in New York. She received her BFA from San Francisco Art Institute in 2016. Sinibaldi's recent solo exhibitions include *Souvenirs and Substitution*, Chapter NY, New York; *Half of Me*, Inge, Plainview, NY; *You're So in Your Head*, Jack Hanley Gallery, New York; *Eye to Eye Delirium*, Interstate Projects, New York; and *Y2K Gallery*, San Francisco. Her work has been included in group and two-person exhibitions at Jack

action share

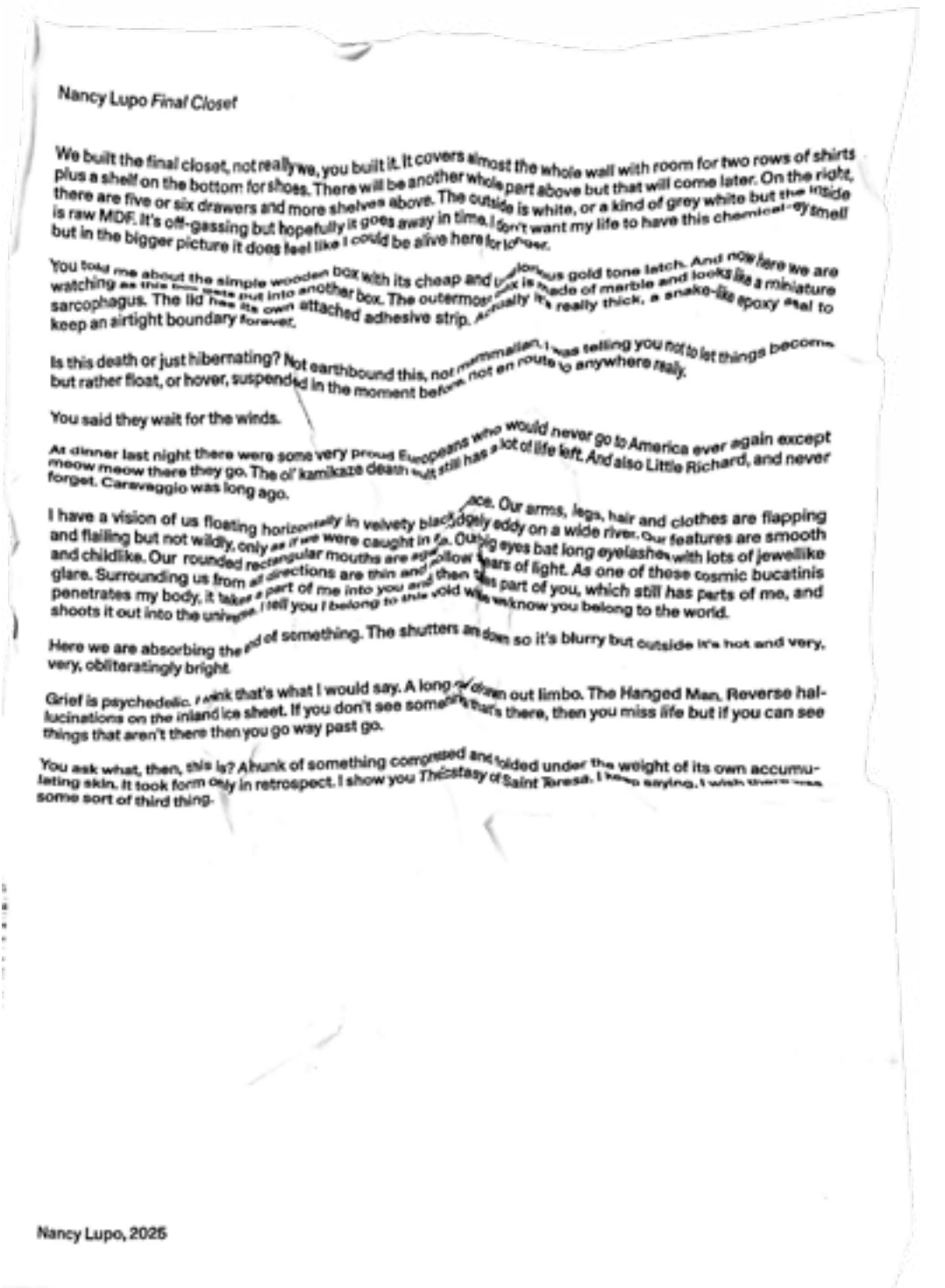
Accessibl

CuratorialText — “Final Closet” by Nancy Lupo

The exhibition was accompanied by Final Closet, a poetic and fragmented text by the artist that expands the project beyond its physical and digital dimensions.

Moving between domestic imagery and abstract reflection, the text introduces themes of containment, preservation, and transformation. Elements such as the closet and the box become metaphors for the archive itself, questioning the idea of storing something stable and definitive.

Rather than explaining the work, the text destabilizes it, creating a suspended space between presence and absence, memory and projection. In this sense, it reinforces the project’s core tension: the archive not as a fixed system, but as something fluid, psychological, and continuously shifting.





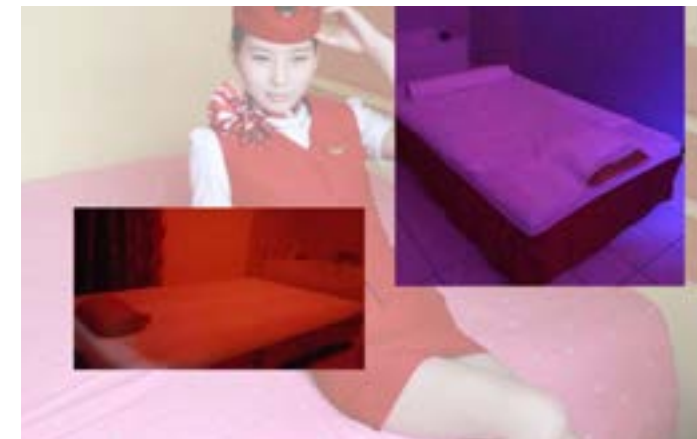
TUINA

Critical Visual Research on Sex Work, Urban Marginality & the Aesthetics of Desire | 2026

TUINA is a visual research project exploring the aesthetics of Chinese massage parlors within the European urban landscape, with a specific focus on Italy.

These spaces operate in a state of visual ambiguity, positioned between care and desire, visibility and concealment. Through signage, lighting, and interior decoration, they construct a highly codified visual language designed to attract, suggest, and negotiate intimacy within the public space.

The project investigates how color, repetition, and visual cues transform anonymous storefronts into charged thresholds, where desire is mediated through design rather than explicitly stated.





CESSI

Visual Research Project & Involuntary Urban Archives | 2024

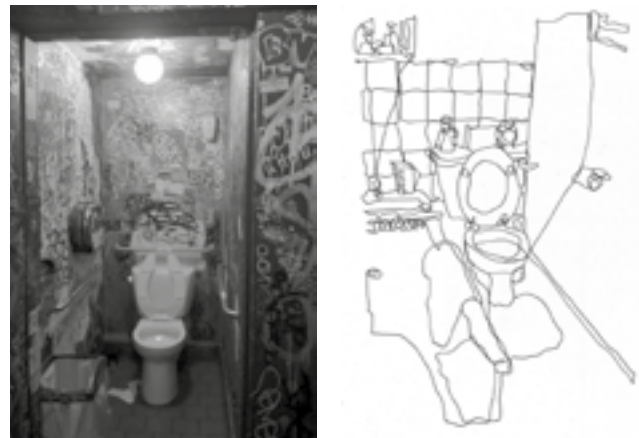
CESSI is an independent visual research project focused on public bathrooms and night venues as marginal yet highly symbolic spaces within urban nightlife.

Often associated with neglect, excess, and anonymity, these environments reveal spontaneous visual systems shaped by use, repetition, and collective behavior. Graffiti, objects left behind, improvised modifications, and traces of bodies turn these spaces into involuntary archives of subcultures and social dynamics.

Through photography and editorial composition, the project documents and reframes these bathrooms as thresholds, places where control loosens and visual expression becomes raw, instinctive, and unfiltered.

CE SSI

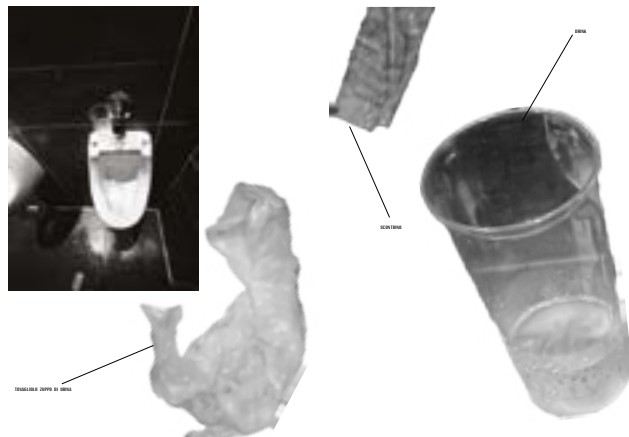
LUGHI APPARENTEMENTE BANALI, SPORCHI E CATTIVI, MA CHE, A UNO SGUARDO ATTENTO E CURIOSO, RIVELANO UNA DIMENSIONE ARTISTICA E CONCETTUALE SORPRENDENTE. OGNI GRAFFITO SULLE PARETI, OGNI SCRITTA INDECENTE, OGNI SEGNO DI USURA DIVENTA UN ELEMENTO DI UNA COMPOSIZIONE ARTISTICA INVOLONTARIA MA POTENTE RIFLETTONDO LE CULTURE, LE SOTTOCULTURE E I MOVIMENTI SOCIALI CHE LI FREQUENTANO.



ARTE SU ARTE BERLINO

BAGNI DELLA COMALA, TORINO.

ARTE DELLE SUBCULTURE CHE LA FREQUENTANO.



ALTRI BAGNI DI GIANCA.



PERCETTIBILE ODORE DI VOMITI

MERCATO DELL'ARTE



CE SSI

"CE SSI"
3049300000
Disegnato a Torino
2014
Una copila unica



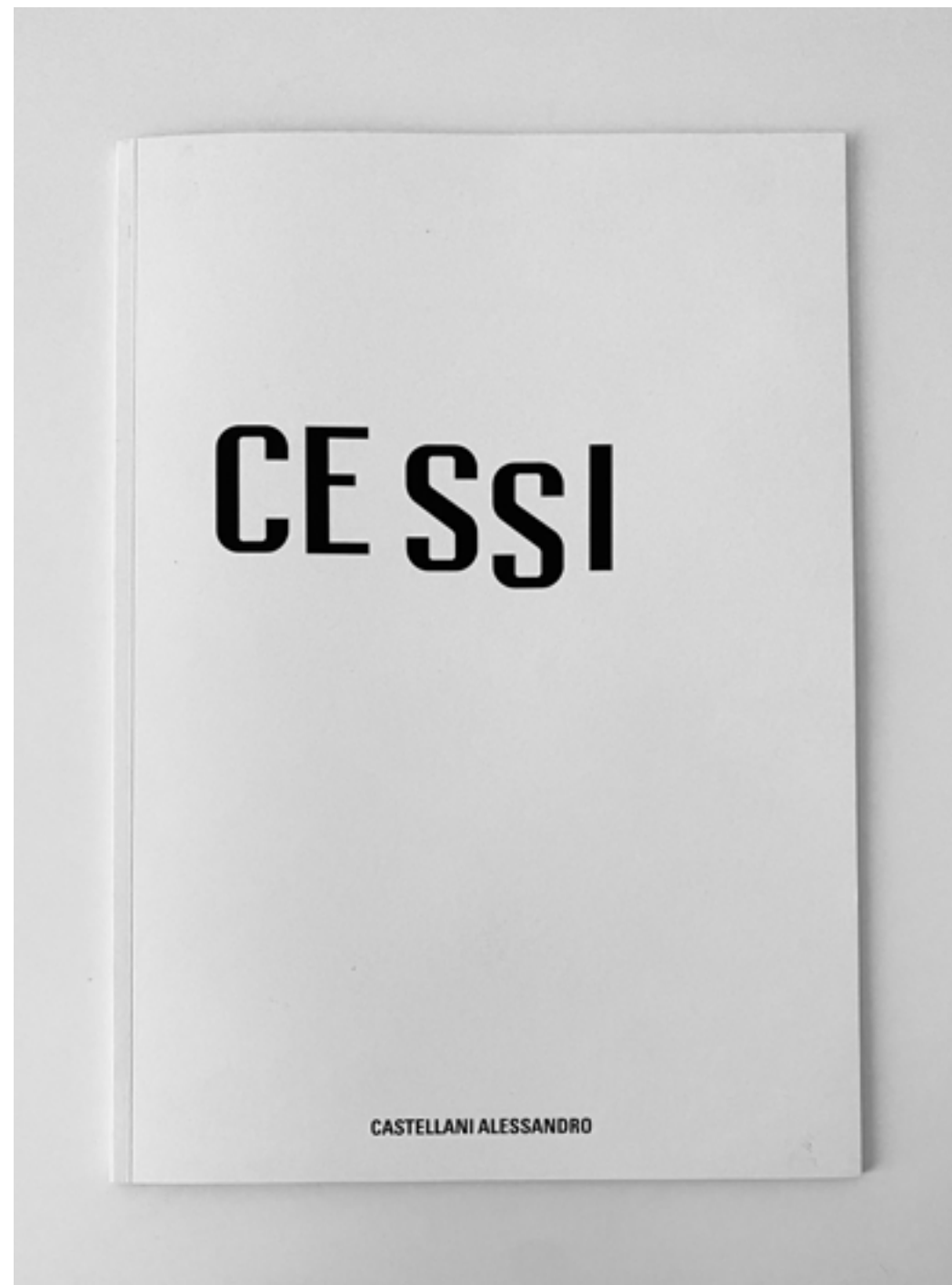
PAPER

I chose a matte coated paper to avoid a glossy “interior magazine” effect, while giving the book greater credibility and aligning it with the visual language of art catalogues.



BINDING

For the binding, I opted for a PUR perfect binding, commonly used for books and magazines. This choice was guided by the intention to echo the clean, white, and smooth lines of sanitary surfaces reflected throughout the publication.



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END OF PACKAGE